Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

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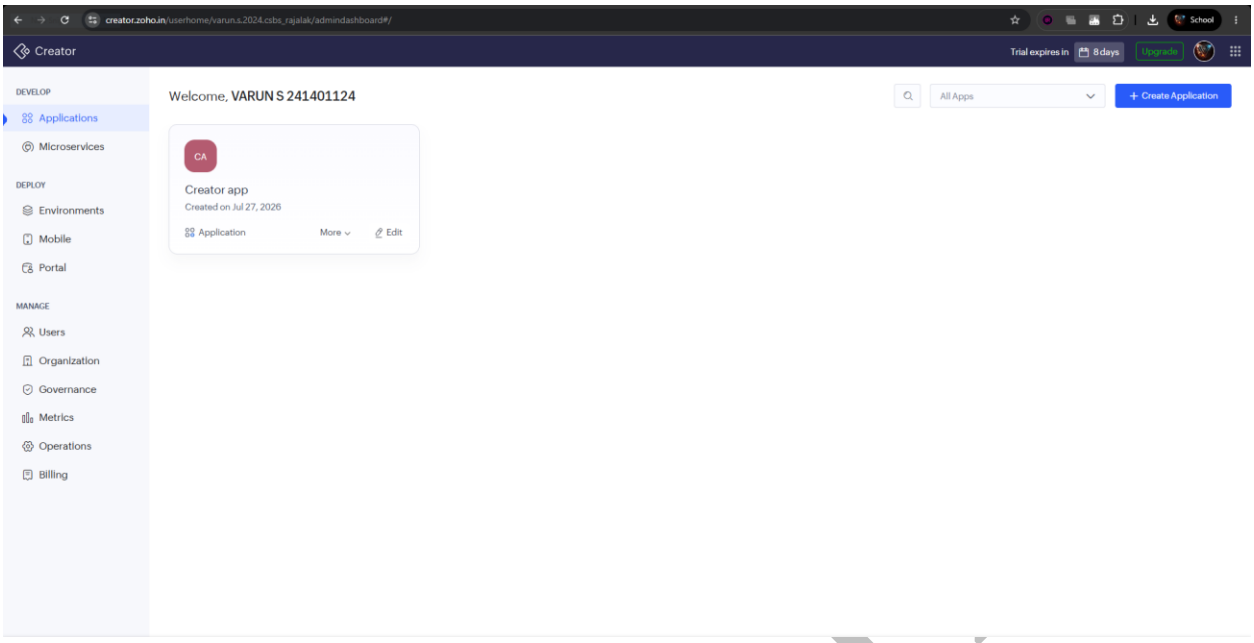
Introduction

Zoho Creator is a powerful low-code application development platform that enables users to create business applications with minimal coding effort. In addition to application development, it provides an Administration Dashboard that helps administrators manage applications, users, security, deployments, and organizational settings from a centralized location. During this exploration, various modules available in the dashboard were studied to understand their functionality and purpose. Each module contributes to the efficient management, deployment, monitoring, and maintenance of applications. This report presents the features and observations made while exploring each module of the Zoho Creator Administration Dashboard.

Applications

The Applications module serves as the primary workspace where all applications created in Zoho Creator are displayed. It allows administrators to create, edit, and organize applications efficiently from a single interface. Users can quickly search for applications and manage them using the available options. The page also displays basic details such as the application name and creation date. During the exploration, one application named Creator App was available, demonstrating how applications are listed and managed. This module acts as the starting point for developing and maintaining business applications.

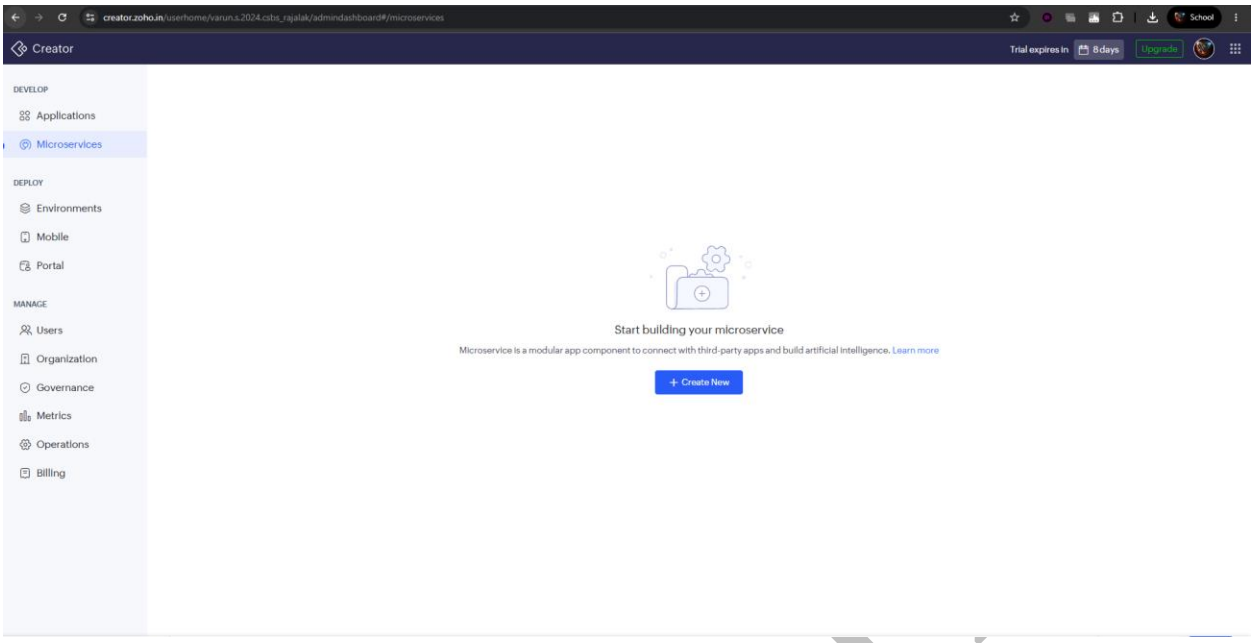
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Microservices

The Microservices module enables developers to create modular services that extend the functionality of existing applications. These services can integrate with third-party platforms, APIs, or artificial intelligence solutions without affecting the main application. Microservices promote reusable and scalable application architecture by separating functionalities into independent components. The dashboard provides an option to create new microservices whenever required. During the exploration, no microservices had been created yet. This module is useful for building flexible and maintainable enterprise applications.

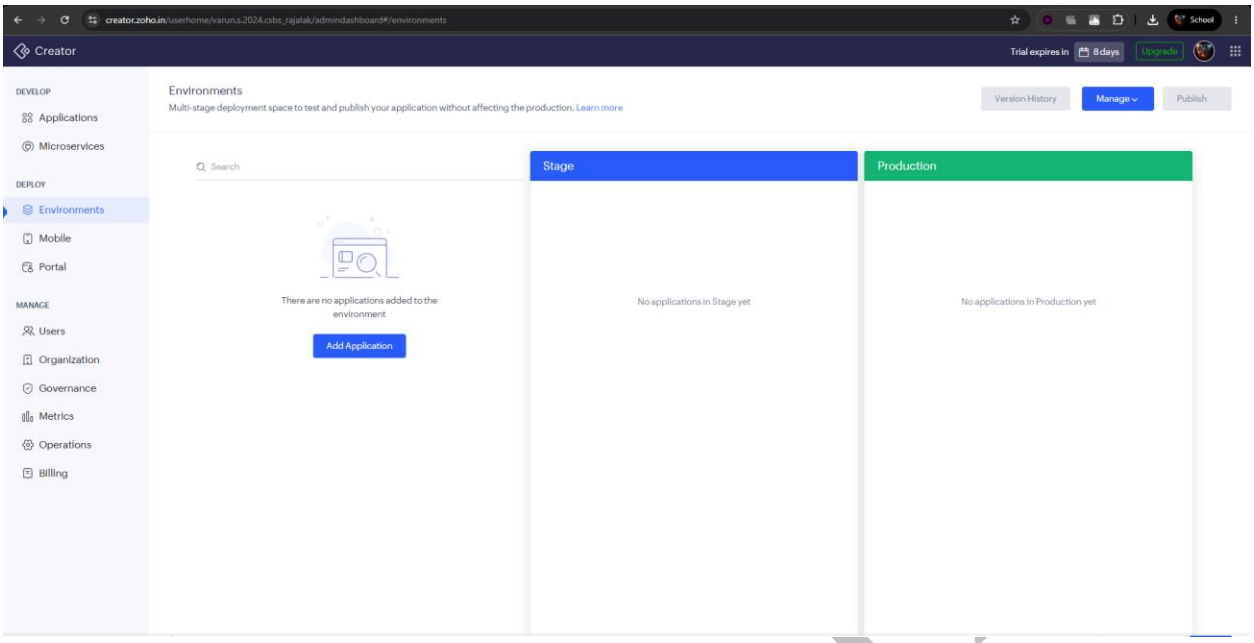
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Environments

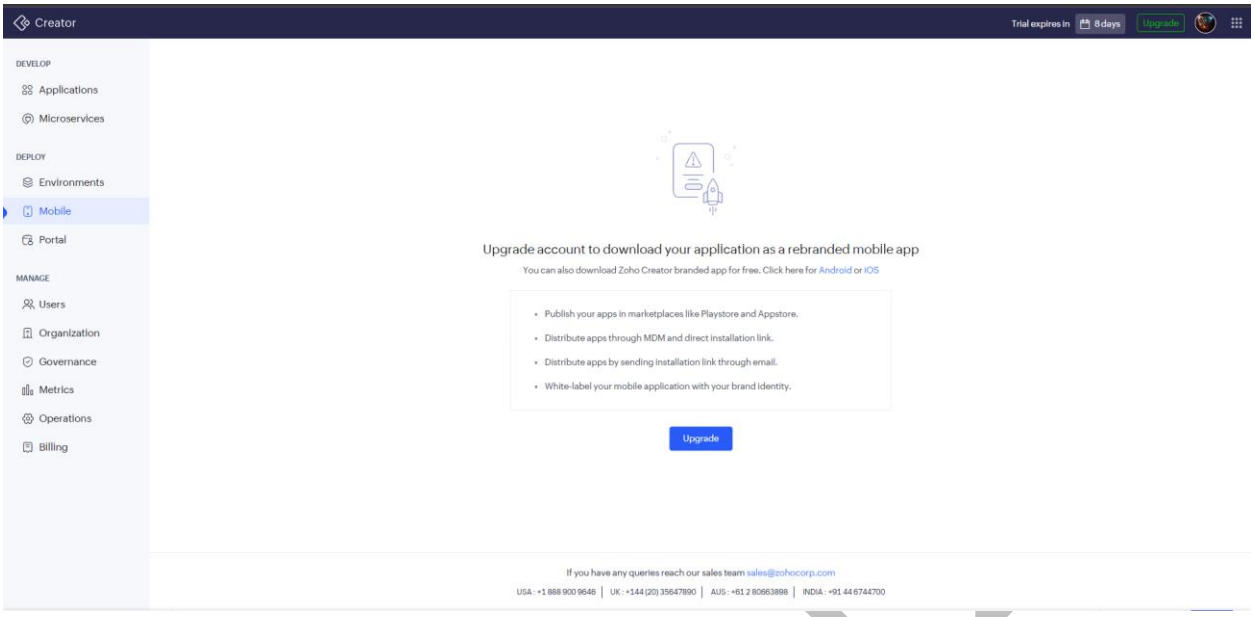
The Environments module supports multi-stage application deployment by separating the development process into Stage and Production environments. Developers can test new features in the Stage environment before publishing them to Production. This approach minimizes the risk of introducing errors into live applications. The module also includes version history and publishing options for better deployment management. During the exploration, no applications were deployed to either environment. This feature ensures safe and organized application deployment.

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Mobile

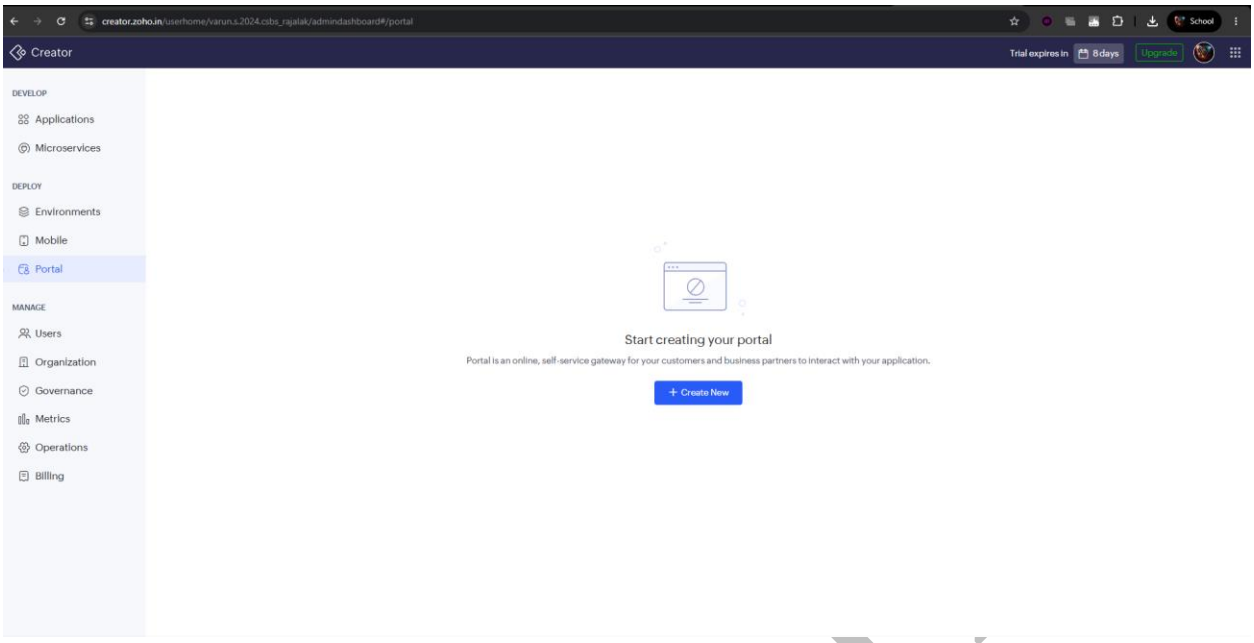
The Mobile module allows organizations to convert their Zoho Creator applications into branded mobile applications for Android and iOS platforms. It supports publishing applications to app stores and distributing them through installation links or Mobile Device Management (MDM). Organizations can also customize the branding of their mobile applications. However, these advanced features are available only in the paid subscription plan. During the trial period, users can access only the Zoho Creator branded mobile application. This module simplifies mobile application deployment for business users.



Portal

The Portal module is designed to create secure online portals for customers, vendors, or external users. It allows organizations to provide controlled access to applications without granting full administrative permissions. Users can interact with forms, reports, and workflows through a secure web portal. The dashboard includes an option to create and configure new portals. During the exploration, no portal had been created. This module enhances collaboration between organizations and external stakeholders.

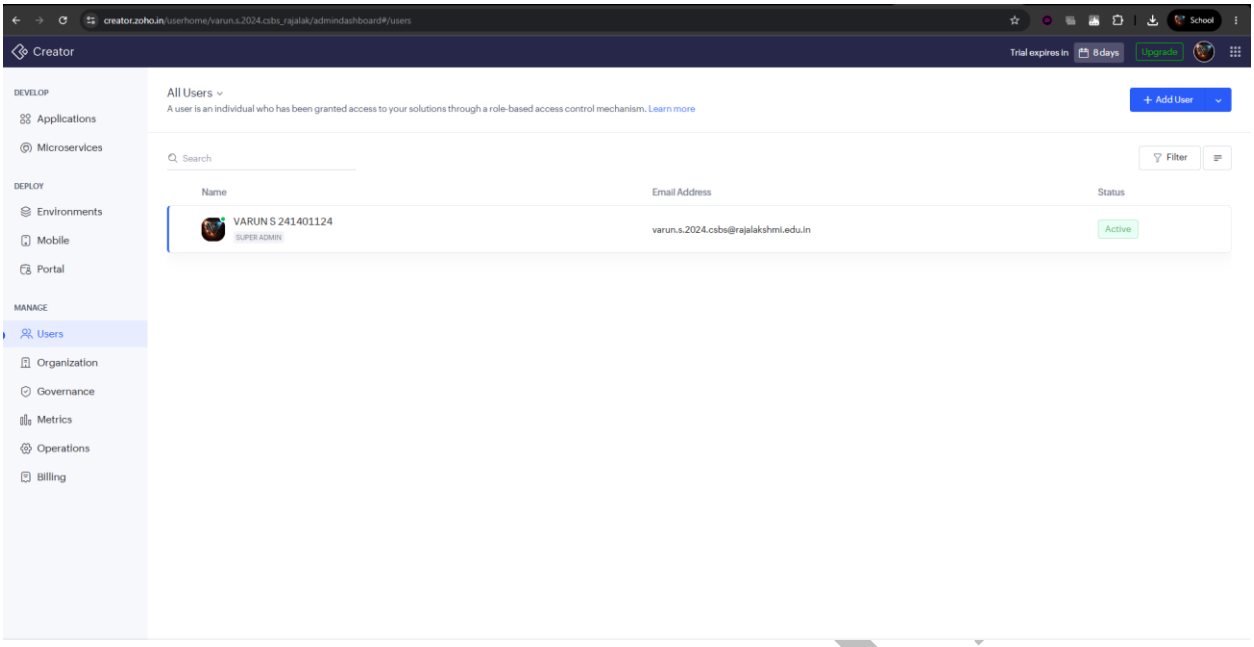
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Users

The Users module is responsible for managing everyone who has access to the Zoho Creator account. Administrators can add new users, assign roles, manage permissions, and monitor user status. Search and filter options make it easier to manage multiple users within an organization. During the exploration, only one active Super Admin user was available in the account. This module ensures secure and organized access management across applications. Proper user management improves both security and collaboration.

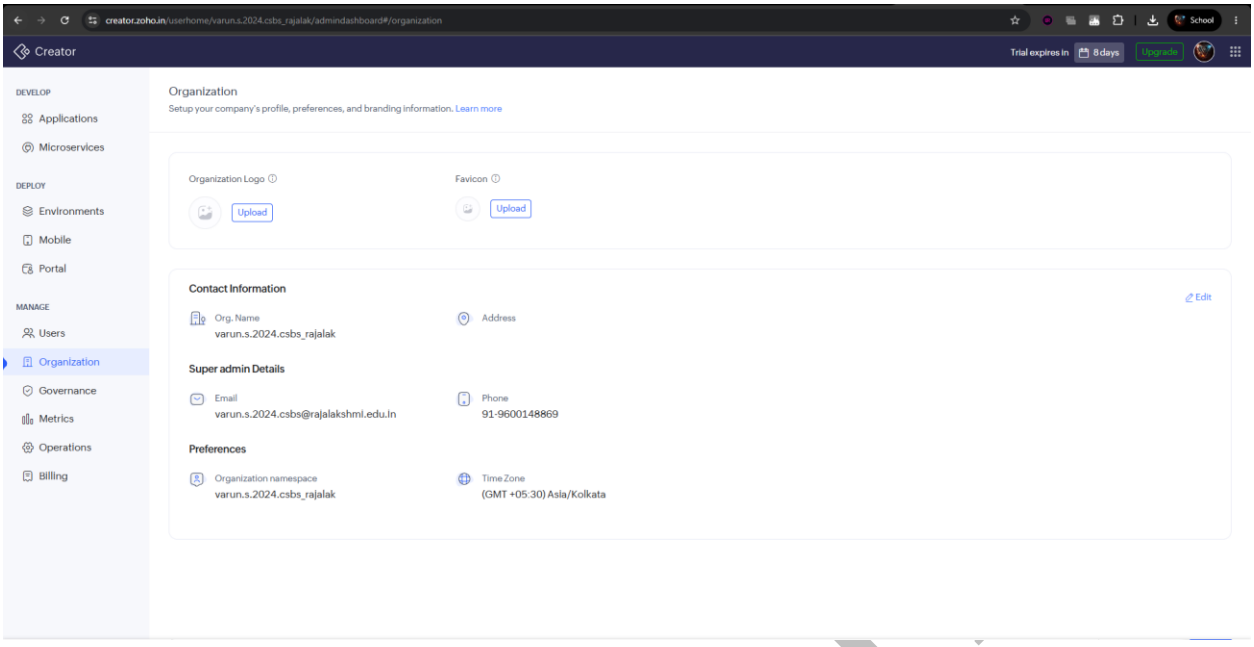
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Organization

The Organization module stores the company's profile, branding, and contact information. Administrators can upload the organization's logo and favicon to personalize their applications. The module also contains details such as the organization name, administrator email, phone number, address, namespace, and timezone. These settings help maintain a professional identity for applications developed within Zoho Creator. During the exploration, the organization's basic details were already configured. This module centralizes all organization-related information.

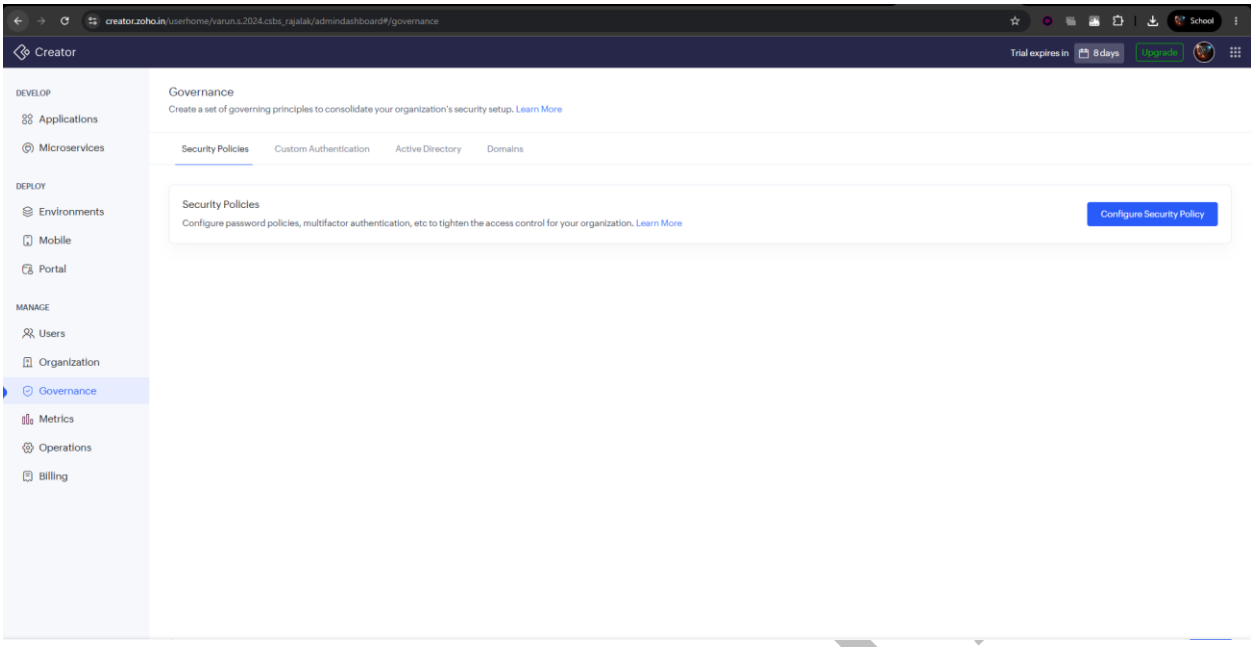
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Governance

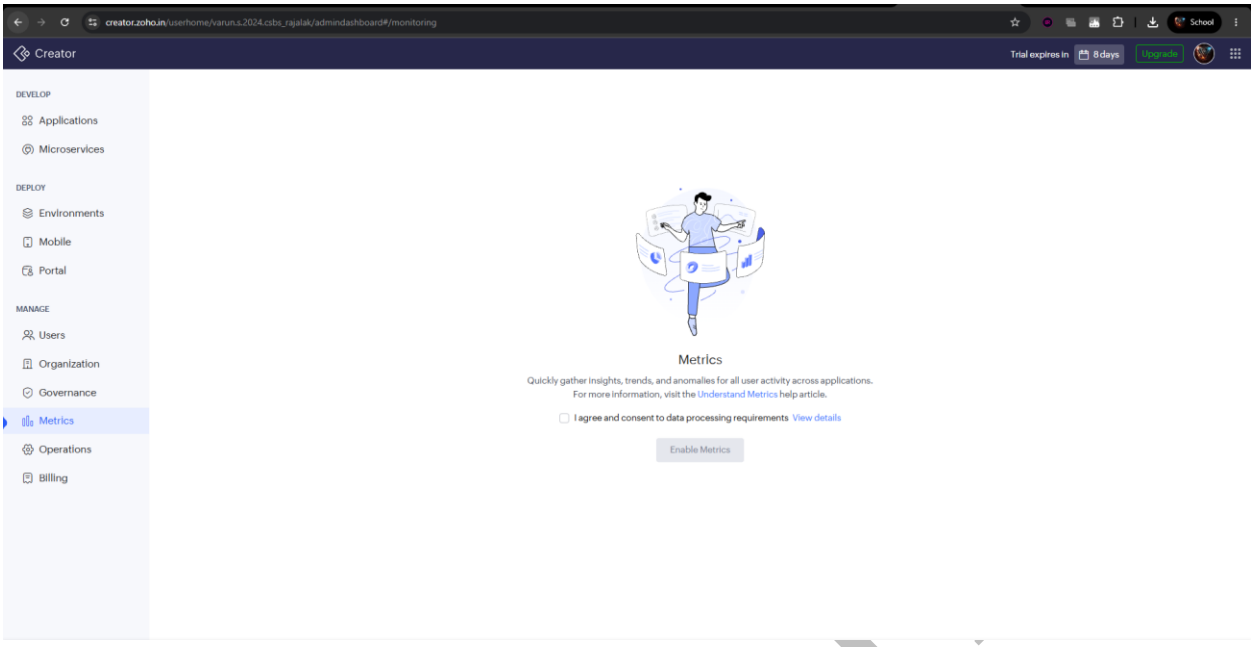
The Governance module focuses on maintaining organizational security and access policies. It allows administrators to configure password policies, enable multi-factor authentication, manage domains, and integrate with Active Directory. These features help strengthen account security and protect organizational resources. The dashboard also provides options for custom authentication methods. During the exploration, security policies had not yet been configured. This module plays an important role in ensuring secure access management.

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Metrics

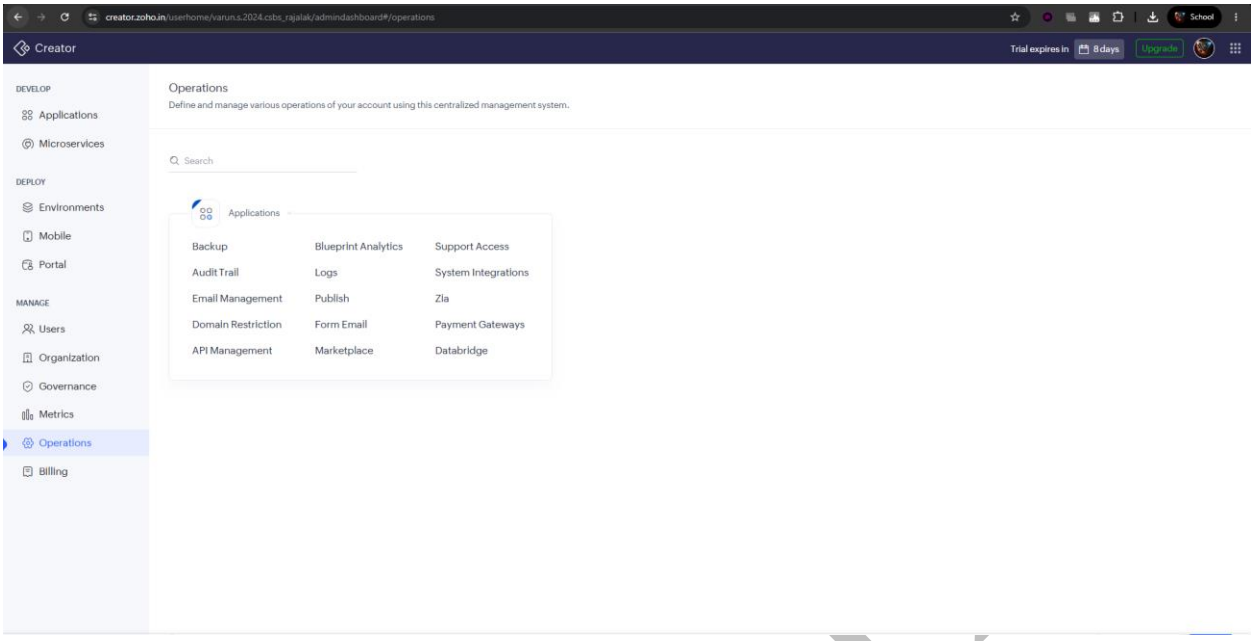
The Metrics module helps administrators monitor application performance and user activity. It provides insights into application usage, user behavior, trends, and system performance. Metrics can assist organizations in identifying unusual activities and improving application efficiency. Before enabling this feature, administrators must provide consent for data processing. During the exploration, metrics collection was disabled. This module supports informed decision-making through performance monitoring and analytics.



Operations

The Operations module acts as a centralized location for managing administrative and maintenance activities. It includes features such as Backup, Audit Trail, Logs, Email Management, API Management, Blueprint Analytics, Marketplace, Payment Gateways, Support Access, Databridge, Publish, and Zia integration. These tools help administrators monitor, maintain, and extend application functionality. The module simplifies operational management by grouping multiple services in one place. During the exploration, all operational options were available for configuration. It is one of the most comprehensive administrative sections of Zoho Creator.

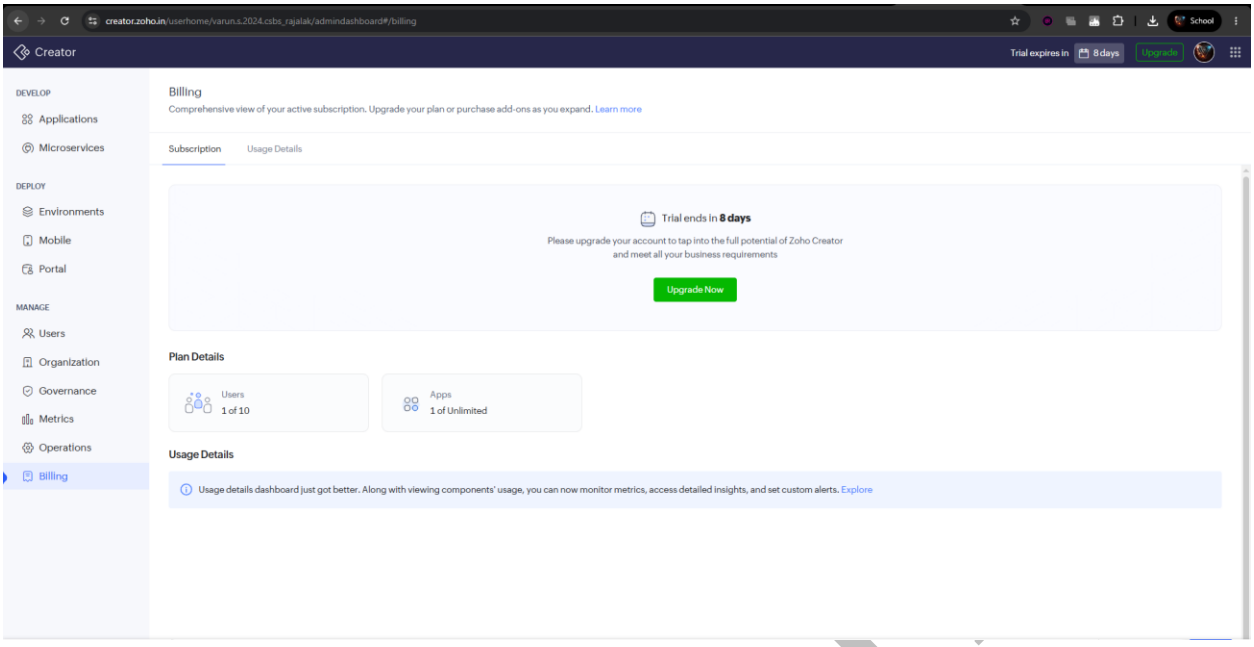
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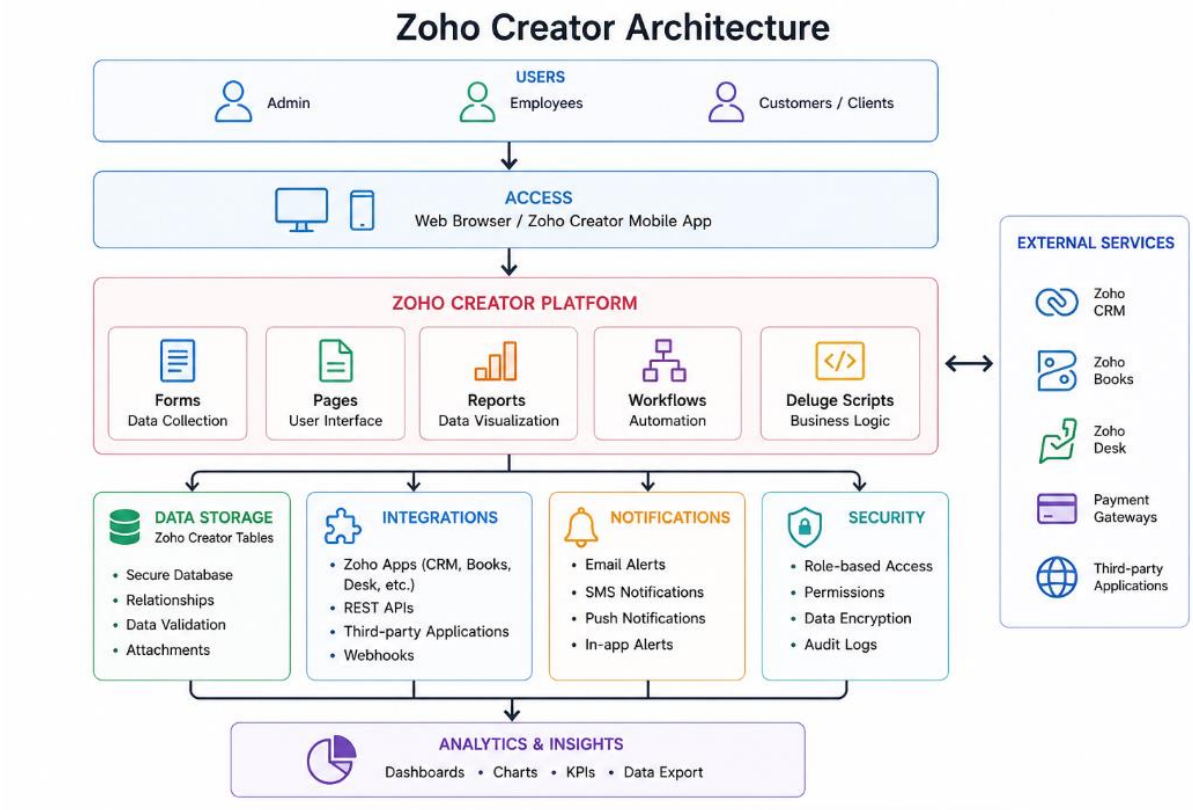
Billing

The Billing module provides information about the organization's subscription plan and account usage. Administrators can monitor the trial period, user limits, application limits, and overall subscription status. The page also provides an option to upgrade to a paid plan for accessing premium features. During the exploration, the account was running on a trial subscription with eight days remaining. It showed support for one application and up to ten users. This module helps organizations manage licensing and resource utilization effectively.

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Architecture



Conclusion

The exploration of the Zoho Creator Administration Dashboard provided a comprehensive understanding of the platform's administrative capabilities. Each module performs a specific function, ranging from application management and user administration to deployment, security, monitoring, and billing. Together, these modules simplify the complete lifecycle of application development and maintenance within a centralized environment. The dashboard offers an intuitive interface that helps administrators efficiently manage resources while ensuring security and scalability. Overall, Zoho Creator demonstrates how a low-code platform can combine application development with powerful administrative tools to support modern business requirements.

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